

A COMPUTER MADE OF BRAINS



Oshiorenaya Agabi's startup Koniku believes that brain-like processors lack one component: actual brains. Koniku is building chips with biological neurons. Rather than mimicking the brain function with chips, Agabi is using the actual material of human brains!
<http://dgit.in/BrainComp>

STAR TREK'S TIME TRAVEL THEORY



Time travel being one of the most interesting devices in Star Trek, however, is also confusing and inconsistent. Do the past alterations get mixed into the current timeline? We tell you all about the theory of time travel in Star Trek.
<http://dgit.in/STTimeTr>

25 HARDEST GAMES OF ALL TIME



Hardcore gamers often complain regarding the difficulty levels being low as newer games are entering the market. From the darkest corners of gaming history, here are 25 hardest video games that made it to the market. How many have you completed already?
<http://dgit.in/HrdstVidG>

PLAYLIST FOR PRODUCTIVITY



Music has the power to influence our working patterns and help us concentrate as well as think efficiently. Different tasks require different levels of concentration and here are the playlists you would want to listen to while working, to ensure maximum output.
<http://dgit.in/ProductivePL>

portable realisation. Experts like Dr. Patel believe that the root cause of Internet disorders or overuse of devices is buried deep in a person's psychology, one that is beyond devices, the internet or technology. Mental health history, living environment, personality traits and even the knowledge of the addiction are enough to further the overuse of technology.

A study concluded by the University of Maryland found out that 'addiction to technology' is similar to 'addiction to drugs'. The research paper was titled 'The World unplugged', in which a very clear majority of over 1000 students from 10 countries were unable to quit their devices voluntarily, even for a single day. Students also admitted to feelings of anxiety and depression when forced to give up their media and technology.

Another study conducted by the Indian Council for Medical Research also found that from the 2,750 participants they studied, there was an "alarming" rate of dependence on technology.

Many other studies like these, coupled with the constant growth of smartphones, tablets and other devices, is what has now given rise to dedicated de-addiction centers. David McNamee of Medical News Today describes them as "Gold Star internet de-addiction centers and treatment programs."

ReStart Life is one such luxury digital de-addiction center based in Redmond, Washington. ReStart Life deals with people who may be addicted to the internet, video games, social media and virtual reality. VR being the most recent addition to their list of digital addictions, even though the population of VR users is still extremely limited. While ReStart Life may be a high-flying retreat for those digital addicts who can afford it, most such de-addiction pro-

grammes limit themselves to internet and gaming addiction treatments. In fact, as per Dr Patel, internet porn and gaming are the two most common addictions that exist in our digital lives today.

With all these internet/device addiction programmes cropping up, a common question that arises is - **How is digital addiction diagnosed?**



Well, because of the lack of research and understanding on the subject, there is no standard way to recognise digital dependency patterns in people, but, Dr. Kimberly Young, a professor at St. Bonaventure University and director of the Center for Internet Addiction Recovery developed an Internet Addiction Test (IAT) to assess symptoms of Internet addiction and compulsive behaviour in adults.

IAT was developed back in 1998 and since then has received a number of updates to keep it current. The purpose of IAT is to measure the severity of online addiction, self reported by users. The test was developed by adapting to the existing criteria for pathological gambling in the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders.

You can take the Internet Addiction Test at <http://dgit.in/IntAddTst>.

While an addiction to technology may be difficult to admit, especially when treatment for this niche disorder can cost a bomb and upwards, there are many real life examples of people losing their minds and bodies

to the overuse of tech. Last year, a 32 year old Taiwanese man was found dead in a gaming cafe after 3 days of binge gaming. The man had suffered a cardiac arrest while playing, although the real reason for him to be at the gaming parlour for 3 days was the fact that he was unemployed for a while and could have been suffering from depression.

Way before in 2005, a Korean man had also lost his life after 50 hours of continuously playing battle simulation game Starcraft.

Selfies, the newest digital addiction, took all of 27 lives in 2015. Most of them were people from India. The Mumbai police has even recognised 15 "no selfie zones" in the city after several such accidents occurred there.

If these examples aren't enough to convince you of the severity of the problem, you will soon be able to see a real-life story of 2 normal teenagers who turned murderers, because of a warped idea from the internet. Directed by Irene Taylor Brodsky, the HBO documentary titled 'Beware the Slenderman' traces the lives of two teenagers, Anissa Weier and Morgan Geyser, who stabbed and murdered their friend, in hopes of finding the mystical castle of Slenderman, a character from the internet who apparently "told them to do it." Can you feel the goosebumps yet?

Now, these are a just handful of the many disturbing examples of how the internet, devices and technology shape our minds and our lives in the digital age. Such instances also beg a very important question - Are we a growing generation of technology addicts? The signs are all there, it's just a matter of time before we wake up, step outside our virtual worlds and smell the coffee! 

<http://dgit.in/TechAddct>